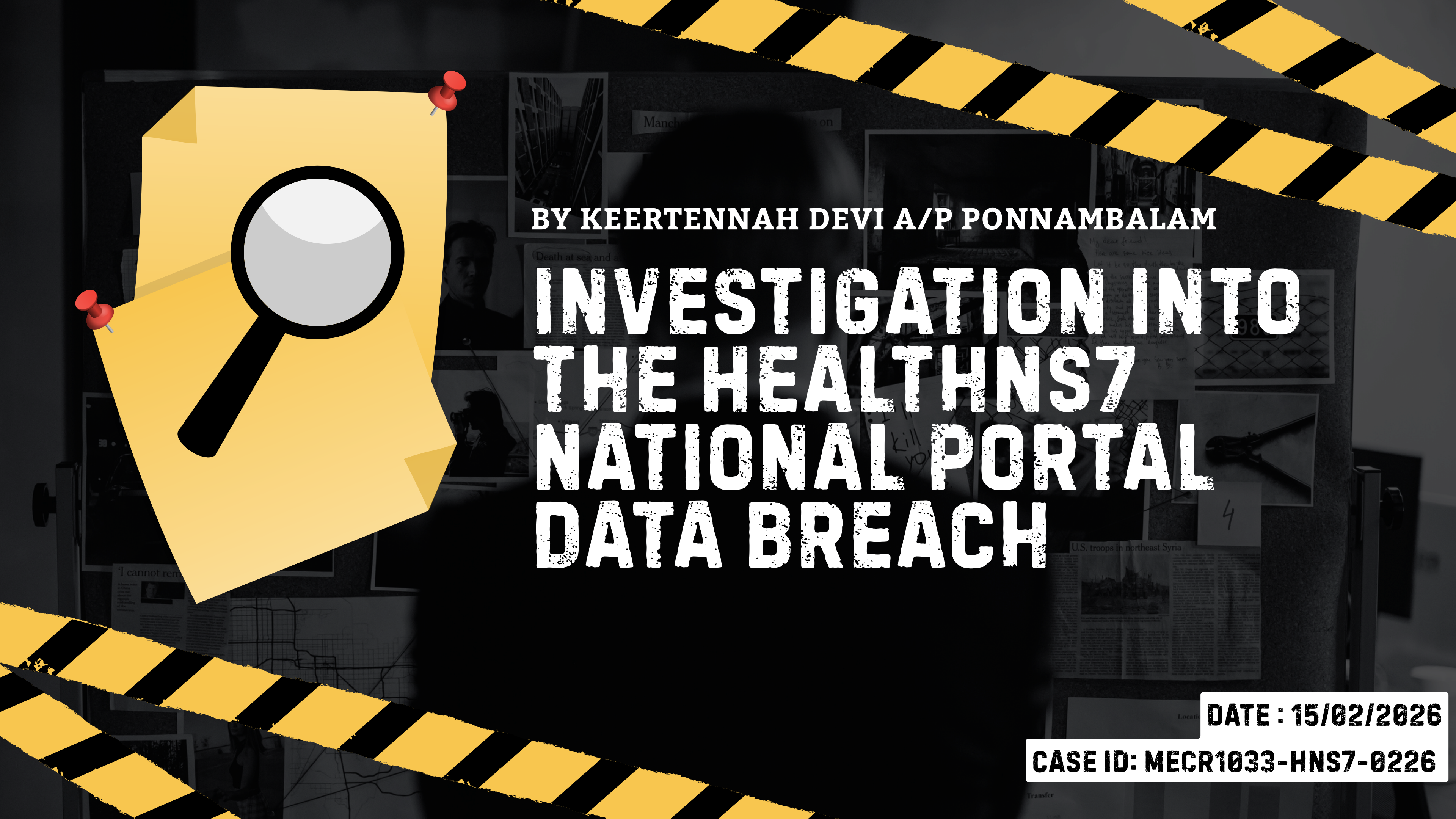




BY KEERTENNAH DEVI A/P PONNAMBALAM

INVESTIGATION INTO THE HEALTHNS7 NATIONAL PORTAL DATA BREACH

DATE : 15/02/2026

CASE ID: MECR1033-HNS7-0226

THE CASE AT A GLANCE

A Phishing Attack Led to the Unauthorized Exposure of Sensitive Patient Data



Breach occurred over a two-week period in Feb, 2026



A single employee workstation was identified as the initial entry point and the device used for data exfiltration.



Confidential medical records of millions of citizens were leaked online.



Evidence Was Handled With Strict Forensic Procedures to Ensure Integrity

EVIDENCE ACQUISITION & INTEGRITY

- The Process:

- A forensic image (bit-for-bit copy) of the employee's hard drive was created using FTK Imager.
- Integrity Verified: The image was hashed (MD5 & SHA-1), creating a unique digital fingerprint. The hash was verified, proving the copy is identical to the original and was not tampered with.

Drive/Image Verify Results

Properties

Name	Evidence_WS01.E01
Sector count	30269568

MD5 Hash

Computed hash	1c382af030dab30ee97caca3247c0e75
Stored verification hash	1c382af030dab30ee97caca3247c0e75
Report Hash	1c382af030dab30ee97caca3247c0e75
Verify result	Match

SHA1 Hash

Computed hash	3a4d0acb0e85409986a0056b9a21e2703ce2c718
Stored verification hash	3a4d0acb0e85409986a0056b9a21e2703ce2c718
Report Hash	3a4d0acb0e85409986a0056b9a21e2703ce2c718
Verify result	Match

Bad Blocks List

Bad block(s) in image

Image Summary

[Computed Hashes]

MD5 checksum: 1c382af030dab30ee97caca3247c0e75
SHA1 checksum: 3a4d0acb0e85409986a0056b9a21e2703ce2c718

Image Information:

Acquisition started: Sun Feb 15 13:55:11 2026

Acquisition finished: Sun Feb 15 14:02:59 2026

Segment list:

D:\HealthNS7_Investigation\Evidence_Images\Evidence_WS01.E01
D:\HealthNS7_Investigation\Evidence_Images\Evidence_WS01.E02
D:\HealthNS7_Investigation\Evidence_Images\Evidence_WS01.E03
D:\HealthNS7_Investigation\Evidence_Images\Evidence_WS01.E04
D:\HealthNS7_Investigation\Evidence_Images\Evidence_WS01.E05
D:\HealthNS7_Investigation\Evidence_Images\Evidence_WS01.E06
D:\HealthNS7_Investigation\Evidence_Images\Evidence_WS01.E07
D:\HealthNS7_Investigation\Evidence_Images\Evidence_WS01.E08
D:\HealthNS7_Investigation\Evidence_Images\Evidence_WS01.E09
COMPUTED HASH : 1c382af030dab30ee97caca3247c0e75
COMPUTED HASH : 3a4d0acb0e85409986a0056b9a21e2703ce2c718

Image Verification Results:

Verification started: Sun Feb 15 14:02:59 2026

Verification finished: Sun Feb 15 14:06:42 2026

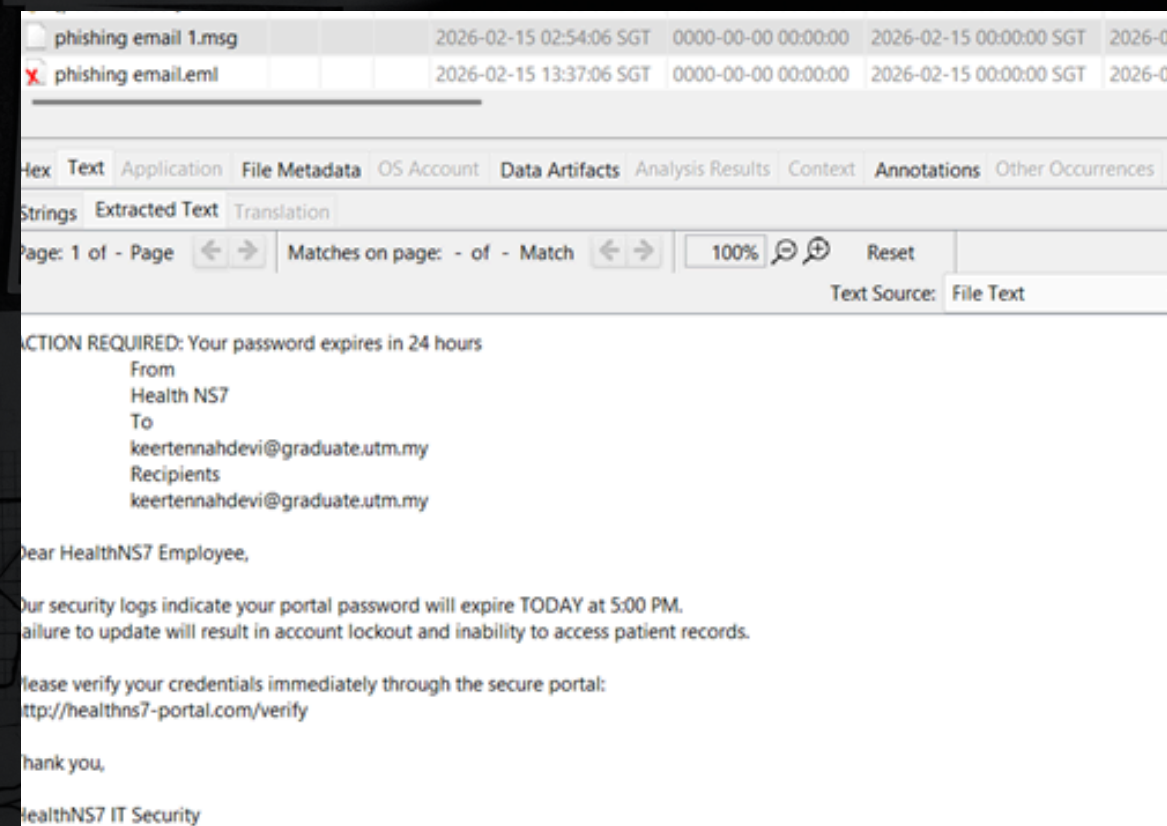
MD5 checksum: 1c382af030dab30ee97caca3247c0e75 : verified
SHA1 checksum: 3a4d0acb0e85409986a0056b9a21e2703ce2c718 : v

OK

The Investigation Uncovered the Initial Point of Compromise

KEY FINDING #1: THE ATTACK VECTOR

- The Evidence:
 - A phishing email titled "Urgent_Action_Required_HealthNS7_Update.eml" was recovered from the employee's machine.
 - This email, designed to look official, tricked the employee into revealing their credentials.



Data Compiled:

The user accessed and compressed sensitive patient records (.csv files) into a .zip archive (found both present and deleted).

KEY FINDING #2: DATA EXFILTRATION

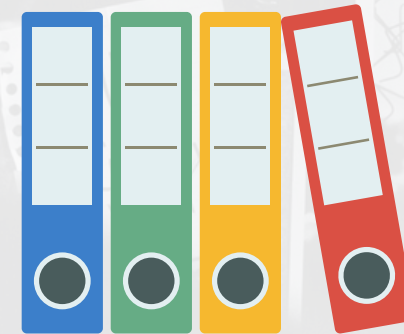
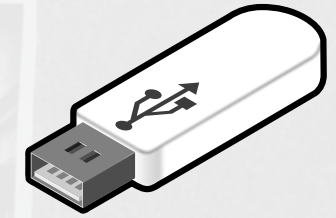
The Investigation Revealed How Sensitive Data Was Removed

Data Leaked:

Data Transferred:

- Browser history showed visits to external file-hosting sites.
- Evidence of an unauthorized cloud storage application was found.
- System logs showed a previously unknown USB device was connected.

The leaked_data.zip file recovered from the dark web matches fragments of the deleted files found on the workstation.



A Timeline of Suspicious Activity Corroborates the Breach

TIMELINE OF EVENTS

Jan 15

Phishing email received and opened (from email metadata).

Jan 18 - Jan 30

Unusual spike in database queries from the employee's workstation (from server logs).

Jan 22 & Jan 28

Files accessed, compressed, and external file-sharing sites visited (from file metadata & browser history).

Jan 29

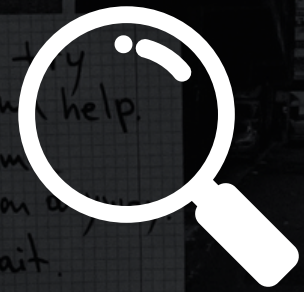
Unknown USB device connected (from USB history).

Feb 1

Leaked data first appears on dark web forums.



FORENSIC FINDINGS CONCLUSIVELY LINK THE EMPLOYEE WORKSTATION TO THE DATA BREACH



CONCLUSION

The workstation was compromised via a phishing email. Sensitive patient data was accessed, staged, and transferred from this machine using multiple methods. The leaked data matches files found on the workstation.

Final Statement: The evidence was collected, handled, and analyzed following industry best practices and is presented here with a complete and verifiable chain of custody. It is our professional opinion that this evidence is sound and admissible in court.